# THE FIVE VOICES: HOW TO COMMUNICATE EFFECTIVELY WITH ANYONE

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# MENTIMETER OPENING ACTIVITY

COMMUNICATION DOESN'T HAPPEN WHEN WE SPEAK.

IT HAPPENS WHEN WE ARE HEARD.

# WHAT HAPPENS WHEN WE AREN'T HEARD

- Teams function at less than 60% of their true potential
- Team leaders rarely, if ever, hear the truth from their people
- 82% of team members feel misunderstood or undervalued
- Leaders undermine their influence every day without even knowing it

*Source: GiANT Worldwide*

# WHAT IF EVERYONE'S VOICE WAS HEARD, VALUED, AND APPRECIATED?

# WHAT IS YOUR LEADERSHIP VOICE?



# THE NURTURER

- *43% of the population, 1/5 volume*
- Nurturers are champions of people and work to take care of everyone around them.
- They are always concerned abbot the relational health and harmony of the group.
- They innately understand how certain actions, behaviors, or initiatives will affect people.

# QUESTIONS THEY ARE ASKING

- “What are people around me going to be most upset about?”
- “Are the leaders really thinking about the people’s best interests?”
- “Don’t others see how people are upset by this decision?”
- “Do the leaders want to hear what I think?”

# POTENTIAL CHALLENGES

- Nurturers can be overly resistant to change and can be passive aggressive.
- They can feel unable to challenge a proposed decision when they disagree.
- Making money is often seen as an impure motive.
- Nurturers don’t usually value the contribution they make.

# THE CREATIVE

- *9% of people, 2/5 volume*
- Creatives are champions of innovation and future ideas.
- They are conceptual architects and are able to see how all the pieces fit together.
- Creatives are never satisfied with the status quo; they always believe it can be better. The word “can’t” isn’t in their vocabulary.

# QUESTIONS THEY ARE ASKING

- “So what? Does all this activity really get us closer to our vision?”
- “Why do people never seem to fully understand my ideas?”
- “Are you a safe person for me to share my ideas with?”
- “Why are we limiting ourselves?”
- “How could we do it better?”

# POTENTIAL CHALLENGES

- They can struggle to celebrate the 90% that has been achieved, focusing instead on the 10% still left to do.
- Idealism can often trump pragmatism, leading to a sense of paralysis until the Creative believes it can be perfect.
- They have a tendency to ignore financial constraints and other practical hurdles.

# THE GUARDIAN

- *30% of people, 3/5 volume*
- Guardians respect and value logic, systems, order, procedure, and process.
- Guardians like to see established track records of success to justify trying something different.
- They can feel frustrated that they are sometimes seen as “raining on the parade” when they are just trying to make sure the team makes the best decision possible.

# QUESTIONS THEY ARE ASKING

- “Is this worth the risk and investment?”
- “Convince me that change is really necessary.”
- “Can we test the hypothesis before we go all in?”
- “Am I at risk of being taken advantage of?”
- “Are we honoring the past as we look toward the future?”

# POTENTIAL CHALLENGES

- Guardians can appear overly critical of people and ideas.
- They have a deep desire for truth and right decisions, which can often override the feelings of others.
- They can interrogate people and lose influence because of their negative response to ideas.
- At times, guardians can be stubborn and slow to compromise if they have a strongly held opinion.

# THE CONNECTOR

- *11% of people, 4/5 volume*
- Connectors rally people around causes and things they believe in.
- Connectors believe in a world where everyone can play and get excited about future opportunities…and they work to make it happen.
- Connectors often respond to challenges with, “Whatever we need, I can get it or I have a source.”

# QUESTIONS THEY ARE ASKING

- “What will make this idea really connect with people?”
- *(When they are explaining an idea and others reject it)* “You really can’t see it?”
- “Is everyone still with me?”
- “Are you aware of what I’ve done?”

# POTENTIAL CHALLENGES

- Connectors can be people pleasers and not bring needed challenge.
- When they feel critiqued, they may sell harder rather than understanding why the other person may not be interested.
- Oftentimes the Connector won’t hear or engage fully with critical feedback.

# THE PIONEER

- *7% of people, 5/5 volume*
- Pioneers approach life with an “anything is possible” attitude.
- They believe visioning a new future is always the highest priority.
- They are always looking for the quickest, fastest, and most efficient way to do things.
- They value “outside the box” thinking and are interested in different ways of doing things.

# QUESTIONS THEY ARE ASKING

- “Who says we can’t?”
- “Do you really not ‘get it’?”
- “Are you competent?”
- “Have you got a proven track record?”

# POTENTIAL CHALLENGES

- They can appear arrogant with a “me-focused” agenda at times.
- Immature Pioneers fail to hear or value all Five Voices.
- They quickly get frustrated with those who don’t “get it.”
- They may exude a “back me or fight me” mentality when they present their ideas.
- They can drive too hard with an insensitivity to the needs of others.

# YOUR FIVE VOICES

- Go back over your scores from each of the Five Voices and put them in order from highest to lowest.
- Spend a few minutes sharing your results with your table group and answering two questions:
  - ***What was your top voice? What about that voice most resonated with you?***
  - ***What voice had the lowest score for you? How does it feel when people communicate with you this way?***

# NEXT STEPS FOR EACH VOICE

- **Nurturers:** Trust that you belong, speak up when you feel compelled, and never stop uplifting others.
- **Creatives:** Celebrate imperfect wins, don’t take challenge personally, and give yourself permission to dream.
- **Guardians:** Pay attention to your tone and tact, be willing to compromise when necessary, and let people know you care.
- **Connectors:** Invite honest feedback from others - and don’t be overly defensive if it isn’t what you want to hear.
- **Pioneers:** Take time to hear others, and remember that you might be wrong. Remember that 93% of people don’t see the world like you do.

# HOW TO HELP EACH VOICE

- **Nurturers:** Invite them to speak first, ask how decisions will affect people, and let them know their contribution matters.
- **Creatives:** Listen past the first draft, help them put their ideas into words, and let them know it’s OK to be wrong.
- **Guardians:** Welcome their questions, give them the details and time to think, and show you’ve done your homework.
- **Connectors:** Give them space to share their ideas, appreciate them before you critique, and keep disagreements warm and relational.
- **Pioneers:** Get to the point, affirm their competence, and push back with confidence when you disagree.

# TAKEAWAYS AND ACTION STEPS

- Using the space at the top of your handout, write down your **biggest takeaway** and your **action step.**
  - Takeaway - What's one thing I learned about myself or others today?
  - Action step - How can I better use my voice, hear others' voices, or communicate with someone whose voice is different than mine?

# ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

- Take the assessment online at 5voices.com
  - Confirms your top voice for free
  - Full profile available for $20 purchase
- Read the Five Voices book
- Subscribe to the Five Voices newsletter at 5voices.com
- Download the Five Voices app

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